Tawaf Al-Ifadah is one of the most important parts of Hajj. It is done after Arafat, Muzdalifah, and Mina.

This Tawaf shows deep love and full submission to Allah (سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَىٰ).

It is a main pillar of Hajj. Without it, the Hajj is not valid. After doing this Tawaf, pilgrims pray behind Maqam Ibrahim, drink Zamzam water, and do Sa'ee if they haven't done it yet.

It is not done in Ihram. If you leave Makkah right after it, it can also count as Tawaf Al-Wida.

This act is both physical and spiritual. It shows your return to Allah (سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَىٰ) with a pure heart.

Understanding Tawaf Al-Ifadah

Tawaf Al-Ifadah is a vital part of the Hajj pilgrimage journey in Saudi Arabia. It involves walking around the Kaaba seven times in a counter-clockwise direction.

This act shows love, submission, and obedience to Allah (سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَىٰ). Every pilgrim performing Hajj must complete it.

It is obligatory. If one omits this Tawaf, his Hajj is not valid. That's how much it matters. It also symbolizes the return to Allah (سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَىٰ) after fulfilling the grand rites of Hajj.

This includes standing in Arafat and overnight stay in Muzdalifah.

Tawaf Al-Ifadah is referred to in the Quran in Surah Al-Hajj (22:29):

"Then let them end their untidiness and fulfill their vows and perform Tawaf around the ancient House."

Scholars interpret this verse to mean Tawaf Al-Ifadah, indicating its position in Hajj ritual or journey order.

Is Tawaf Al-Ifadah Mandatory?

Yes, it is mandatory as it is considered one of the four pillars of Hajj:

1. **Ihram** – the holy state required for Hajj.
2. **Wuquf Arafah** (Standing in Arafat) – the core rite of Hajj.
3. **Tawaf Al-Ifadah** – the central circumambulation.
4. **Sa'ee** – walking between Safa and Marwah.

Unless a Muslim performs Tawaf Al-Ifadah around the Kaaba, Hajj is invalid.

Even if they complete all the rest of the rituals, they have to do this Tawaf in order to complete their pilgrimage.

It's not a Sunnah or a suggestion, it is a *requirement*.

However, menstruating women may postpone Tawaf Al-Ifadah until their menses are over.

Scholars concur that they should wait to be clean first before doing it. That's how important it is.

When Should You Perform Tawaf Al-Ifadah?

Tawaf Al Ifadah is typically performed on the 10th of Dhul Hijjah around the Kaaba, after:

- Standing at Arafat (9th Dhul Hijjah)
- Spending overnight in Muzdalifah
- Pelting Jamrat Al-Aqabah (the big pillar in Mina)
- Providing the animal sacrifice
- Shaving or cutting the hair

After these are done, pilgrims proceed to the Masjid Al-Haram to carry out this Tawaf.

However, not everyone is able to do it on the 10th due to overcrowding or medical reasons. Don't worry.

Scholars advise that it can be carried out on any of the 'Days of Tashreeq' (11th to 13th of Dhul Hijjah) or even later.

It can be delayed till the 14th or even 15th if there is a valid reason. But it should be done as early as possible, particularly if you intend to depart soon from Makkah.

It's why it is also called the 'farewell' tawaf or Al Wida.

Tawaf Al-Ifadah vs Tawaf Al-Wida

First-time pilgrims often confuse these two kinds of Tawaf during their holy journey.

But they are for two very different reasons.

Dua for Arafat:
The best and most highly recommended supplication (*dua*) for the Day of Arafat is the one mentioned by the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).

The Core Dua of Arafat

The best supplication on the Day of Arafat is the affirmation of Allah's oneness:

لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللهُ وَحْدَهُ لَا شَرِيكَ لَهُ، لَهُ الْمُلْكُ وَلَهُ الْحَمْدُ، وَهُوَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ

- **Transliteration:** Lā ilāha illallāhu waḥdahu lā sharīka lah, lahul-mulku wa lahul-ḥamdu, wa huwa 'alā kulli shay'in qadīr.
- **Translation:** "There is no true god except Allah, alone with no partner. To Him belongs the dominion and to Him belongs all praise, and He is capable of all things."

Other Highly Recommended Duas & Dhikr

Since Arafat is the most critical day for forgiveness, your time should be split between praise, seeking forgiveness, and asking for your worldly and afterlife needs.

- **For Forgiveness (The Master of Seeking Forgiveness - *Sayyidul Istighfar*):**

اللَّهُمَّ أَنْتَ رَبِّي لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، خَلَقْتَنِي وَأَنَا عَبْدُكَ، وَأَنَا عَلَى عَهْدِكَ وَوَعْدِكَ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُ...

- **Translation:** "O Allah, You are my Lord, there is no deity except You. You created me and I am Your servant, and I am faithful to my covenant and my promise to You as much as I can..."

- **For Goodness in Both Worlds:**

رَبَّنَا آتِنَا فِي الدُّنْيَا حَسَنَةً وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ حَسَنَةً وَقِنَا عَذَابَ النَّارِ

- **Transliteration:** Rabbanā ātinā fid-dunyā ḥasanatan wa fil-ākhirati ḥasanatan wa qinā ‘adhāban-nār.
- **Translation:** "Our Lord, give us in this world [that which is] good and in the Hereafter [that which is] good and protect us from the punishment of the Fire."

- **General Dhikr:**
  - Repeat **Subḥānallāh, Alḥamdulillāh, Lā ilāha illallāh, and Allāhu Akbar**.
  - Send abundant blessings upon the Prophet (**Salawat**).

Tips for Making Dua on Arafat

- **Raise your hands** and face the Qiblah.
- Be in a **state of Wudu** (ablution).
- **Be persistent and certain** (*Yaqeen*) that Allah will accept your prayers.
- Cry and express your complete dependency on Him.
- Include your parents, family, and the global Muslim community (*Ummah*) in your prayers.

إليك الترجمة العربية الدقيقة والمنسقة للنص المذكور حول **طواف الإفاضة** و**دعاء يوم عرفة**:

فهم طواف الإفاضة

يُعد **طواف الإفاضة** من أهم وأعظم مناسك الحج. وهو يُؤدى بعد النفرة من عرفة، والمبيت بمزدلفة، والمكوث بمنى. يُمثل هذا الطواف تعبيراً عن الحب العفيف والخضوع التام لله (سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَىٰ)، وهو ركن أساسي من أركان الحج لا يصح الحج بدونه.

بعد أداء هذا الطواف، يصلي الحجاج خلف مقام إبراهيم، ويشربون ماء زمزم، ويؤدون السعي بين الصفا والمروة إن لم يكونوا قد أدوه مسبقاً. ولا يُؤدى هذا الطواف في حالة الإحرام الكامل (بعد التحلل). وإذا غادر الحاج مكة فور الانتهاء منه، فيمكن أن يُجزئ ويُحتسب أيضاً كطواف الوداع. إن هذا النسك يجمع بين البعدين البدني والروحي، ليعكس رجوع العبد إلى ربه بقلب طاهر نقي.

مكانة طواف الإفاضة في القرآن الكريم

يُشار إلى طواف الإفاضة في القرآن الكريم في سورة الحج (الآية 29):

"ثُمَّ لِيَقْضُوْا تَفَثَهُمْ وَلْيُوْفُوْا نُذُوْرَهُمْ وَلْيَطَّوَّفُوا بِالْبَيْتِ الْعَتِيْقِ"

يفسر العلماء هذه الآية الكريمة على أنها إشارة واضحة إلى طواف الإفاضة، مما يبرز منزلته العظيمة في الترتيب الزمني لمناسك الحج.

هل طواف الإفاضة فرض (واجب)؟

نعم، هو فرض ركني لا يسقط بحال، إذ يُعد واحداً من أركان الحج الأربعة المتفق عليها:

1. **الإحرام:** النية والدخول في النسك.
2. **الوقوف بعرفة:** الركن الأعظم للحج.
3. **طواف الإفاضة:** الطواف الأساسي حول الكعبة المشرفة.
4. **السعي:** المشي بين الصفا والمروة.

ما لم يؤدِّ المسلم طواف الإفاضة حول الكعبة، فإن حجه يظل باطلًا. وحتى لو أتم سائر المناسك الأخرى، فلا بد من أدائه لإتمام صحة الحج. إنه ليس سنة ولا مستحباً، بل هو متطلب قطعيّ الوجوب.

استثناء للمرأة الحائض: يجوز للمرأة الحائض تأخير طواف الإفاضة حتى تنقضي فترة حيضها وتطهر. وقد أجمع العلماء على وجوب انتظارها حتى تغتسل وتطهر قبل أدائه، لعظم شأنه.

متى يُؤدى طواف الإفاضة؟

يُؤدى طواف الإفاضة عادةً في **يوم النحر (العاشر من ذي الحجة)** حول الكعبة المشرفة، وذلك بعد القيام بالأمور التالية:

- الوقوف بعرفة (9 ذي الحجة)
- المبيت بمزدلفة
- رمي جمرة العقبة الكبرى (بمنى)
- ذبح الهدي (الأضحية)
- الحلق أو التقصير (للرجال والنساء)

بعد إتمام هذه الأعمال، يتوجه الحجاج إلى المسجد الحرام لأداء طواف الإفاضة. ومع ذلك، نظراً للازدحام الشديد أو لأسباب صحية وطارئة قد تعيق بعض الحجاج، **فلا حرج في تأخيره**.

يُشير العلماء إلى جواز أدائه في أي من **أيام التشريق (الحادي عشر والثاني عشر والثالث عشر من ذي الحجة)** أو حتى بعدها. ويمكن تأخيره إلى الرابع عشر أو الخامس عشر من ذي الحجة إذا دعت الحاجة أو وُجد عذر معتبر، ولكن يُستحب المبادرة به في أسرع وقت ممكن، سيما لمن ينوي مغادرة مكة قريباً (ولهذا يُسمى أحياناً بطواف "الوداع").

طواف الإفاضة مقابل طواف الوداع

غالباً ما يخلط الحجاج في سفرتهم الأولى بين هذين النوعين من الطواف، على الرغم من اختلاف غاياتهما كلياً.

دعاء يوم عرفة

يُعد يوم عرفة أعظم أيام السنة للدعاء، وأفضل ما ورد فيه هو ما ذكره النبي محمد (صلى الله عليه وسلم).

الدعاء الأساسي في يوم عرفة

أفضل ما يُدعى به في يوم عرفة هو إقرار التوحيد والتعظيم لله عز وجل:

- **النص العربي:** لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَحْدَهُ لَا شَرِيكَ لَهُ، لَهُ الْمُلْكُ وَلَهُ الْحَمْدُ، وَهُوَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ.
- **الترجمة الإنجليزية (للتوضيح):** "There is no true god except Allah ,alone with no partner .To Him belongs the dominion and to Him belongs all praise ,and He is capable of all things".

أدعية وأذكار أخرى موصى بها بشدة

بما أن يوم عرفة هو موطن إجابة الدعاء والمغفرة الكبرى، فيستحب تقسيم الوقت بين الثناء على الله، وطلب المغفرة، والدعاء بحوائج الدنيا والآخرة:

- **لطلب المغفرة (سيد الاستغفار):**

اللَّهُمَّ أَنْتَ رَبِّي لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، خَلَقْتَنِي وَأَنَا عَبْدُكَ، وَأَنَا عَلَى عَهْدِكَ وَوَعْدِكَ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُ...

- **لطلب الخير في الدارَيْن:**

رَبَّنَا آتِنَا فِي الدُّنْيَا حَسَنَةً وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ حَسَنَةً وَقِنَا عَذَابَ النَّارِ.

- **الأذكار العامة:**
    - الإكثار من قول: **سبحان الله، والحمد لله، ولا إله إلا الله، والله أكبر.**
    - الإكثار من الصلاة والسلام على النبي صلى الله عليه وسلم (الصلوات).

نصائح وآداب الدعاء يوم عرفة

- رفع اليدين واستقبال القبلة.
- الحرص على الطهارة والوضوء.
- الإلحاح في الدعاء مع اليقين التام (اليقين) بأن الله سيستجيب.
- التذلل والبكاء وإظهار الافتقار الكامل لله تعالى.
- شمول الوالدين، والعائلة، وعموم الأمة الإسلامية بالدعاء.

تمام، هذا **ترجمة النص إلى اللغة العربية**.
(الترجمة فصيحة ومناسبة للاستخدام الأكاديمي أو كدليل إرشادي)

ما هو الحج؟

في كل عام، يؤدي ملايين المسلمين من جميع أنحاء العالم فريضة الحج، وهي الحج المقدس والركن الخامس من أركان الإسلام.

يُؤدَّى الحج في مكة المكرمة، في المملكة العربية السعودية حاليًا، خلال شهر ذي الحجة، وهو الشهر الثاني عشر في التقويم الهجري.

الحج فريضة وواجب ديني، وهو أحد أركان الإسلام، أي يجب على كل مسلم أن يؤديه مرة واحدة في حياته إذا كان قادرًا ماليًا وبدنيًا ونفسيًا. ويجوز أداء الحج أكثر من مرة بشرط الإخلاص وابتغاء رضا الله سبحانه وتعالى.

قال الله تعالى في القرآن الكريم:

﴿وَلِلَّهِ عَلَى النَّاسِ حِجُّ الْبَيْتِ مَنِ اسْتَطَاعَ إِلَيْهِ سَبِيلًا ۚ وَمَنْ كَفَرَ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ غَنِيٌّ عَنِ الْعَالَمِينَ﴾
(سورة آل عمران: 97)

بالنسبة لمن يستعد لأداء الحج، فهي فترة مليئة بالحماس والفرح، لكنها أيضًا فترة ذات أهمية روحية عظيمة، إذ إن الحج لأول مرة قد يكون تجربة لا تتكرر في حياة المسلم.

الحج اختبار للصبر وضبط النفس، وهو تحدٍّ روحي ونفسي وبدني، لكنه يمنح المسلمين فرصة لتجديد إيمانهم، وتكفير ذنوبهم، والتقرب إلى الله سبحانه وتعالى.

وقال رسول الله ﷺ:

«من حج فلم يرفث ولم يفسق رجع كيوم ولدته أمه»
(متفق عليه – البخاري ومسلم)

يُؤدَّى الحج في الفترة ما بين 8 إلى 12 من شهر ذي الحجة. وبما أن المسلمين يعتمدون على التقويم القمري، فإن التواريخ الميلادية تختلف من عام إلى آخر.
وفي عام 2024، أُقيم الحج من 14 يونيو إلى 19 يونيو ميلاديًا.

سيساعدك هذا الدليل الشامل للحج على فهم مختلف جوانب هذه الفريضة العظيمة، بدءًا من أصلها وحتى كيفية أدائها خطوة بخطوة.

قصة الحج

رغم أن النبي محمد ﷺ هو من علّم المسلمين مناسك الحج، إلا أن أصل الحج يعود إلى النبي إبراهيم عليه السلام، قبل آلاف السنين.

بدأ النبي محمد ﷺ الحج في عام 628 ميلادي خلال شهر ذي الحجة، وهو نفس الحج الذي يؤديه المسلمون اليوم.
لكن شهر ذي الحجة كان شهرًا مقدسًا أيضًا عند العرب قبل الإسلام، حيث كان القتال محرّمًا، وكانوا يحجون إلى الكعبة التي كانت آنذاك تضم الأصنام.

تُعرف الكعبة اليوم باسم **بيت الله**، وهي جزء أساسي من مناسك الحج، لكنها مسجد وليست معبودًا.
وقد بُنيت الكعبة بأمر الله على يد النبي إبراهيم عليه السلام، ولهذا يؤدي المسلمون الحج.

هاجر وإسماعيل وبئر زمزم

كان من أعظم ابتلاءات إبراهيم عليه السلام ترك زوجته هاجر وابنه إسماعيل عليه السلام في صحراء مكة بأمر من الله.
نفد الطعام والماء، وبحثت هاجر بين جبلي الصفا والمروة عن الماء، حتى تفجّر بئر زمزم بمعجزة من الله سبحانه وتعالى، وهو ماء ما زال موجودًا إلى يومنا هذا.

أصبح هذا المكان سببًا لازدهار مكة، وعندما عاد إبراهيم عليه السلام رأى ثمرة إيمانه بالله.

بناء الكعبة ونشأة الحج

في موضع بئر زمزم، أُمر إبراهيم عليه السلام ببناء الكعبة بمساعدة ابنه إسماعيل عليه السلام، لتكون مكانًا لعبادة الله وحده.

ومع مرور الزمن، انحرف الناس إلى عبادة الأصنام، حتى بعث الله النبي محمد ﷺ الذي أعاد الكعبة إلى غايتها الأصلية وأعاد فريضة الحج.
وأُدي أول حج إسلامي كامل عام 632 ميلادي.

الحج في عصرنا الحاضر

اليوم، يسافر أكثر من 2.5 مليون مسلم من مختلف الأعراق والثقافات إلى مكة كل عام لأداء مناسك الحج، متساوين أمام الله سبحانه وتعالى.

من يجب عليه الحج؟

الحج ركن من أركان الإسلام الخمسة:

1. الشهادة
2. الصلاة
3. الزكاة
4. الصيام

5. الحج

ويجب الحج على:

- المسلم البالغ
- القادر صحيًا
- القادر ماليًا (غير المديون إلا بإذن الدائن)

خطوات الحج بإيجاز (19 خطوة)

1. النية والاستعداد
2. الإحرام
3. الطواف (7 أشواط)
4. السعي بين الصفا والمروة
5. الحلق أو التقصير (انتهاء العمرة)
6. الراحة والعبادة
7. الإحرام مرة أخرى
8. المبيت في منى
9. يوم عرفة
10. المبيت في مزدلفة
11. رمي الجمرات
12. الهدي
13. الحلق
14. طواف الإفاضة
15. السعي
16. رمي الجمرات
17. المبيت في منى
18. رمي الجمرات
19. طواف الوداع

ختامًا

🤍 **حج مبرور وسعي مشكور**
ومن لم يستطع الحج، فإن أيام العشر من ذي الحجة من أعظم أيام السنة، ويُستحب فيها الذكر، والصيام، والصدقة، والتكبير، والتهليل.

قال رسول الله ﷺ:

«ما من أيام العمل الصالح فيها أحب إلى الله من هذه الأيام العشر»
(رواه أحمد)

إذا تحب:

- أرتّب الترجمة في **ملف** **Word** أو **PDF**
- أختصرها للعرض أو التقرير
- أترجمها **بلغة عربية بسيطة** للأطفال أو العامة

What Is Hajj?

Each year, millions of Muslims from all across the world perform *Hajj*, the sacred pilgrimage and the fifth pillar of Islam.

Hajj takes place in Makkah, in modern day Saudi Arabia, during the holy month of Dhul Hijjah, the 12th month in the Islamic calendar.

Hajj is a spiritual duty and **a pillar of Islam**, meaning that *Hajj* **must be performed by every Muslim at least once in their lifetime,** so long as they are financially, physically, and emotionally able to do so. Going more than once during your lifetime is permitted whilst sincerely seeking Allah's (SWT) (which means 'The Most Glorified, The Most High) pleasure.

Allah (SWT) says to the Muslims in the Qur'an:

> And [due] to Allah from the people is a pilgrimage to the House – for whoever is able to find thereto a way. But whoever disbelieves – then indeed, Allah is free from need of the worlds.

Qur'an | 3:97

For anyone preparing to perform *Hajj*, it's an incredibly exciting time, but also a time of great spiritual importance – the first time going can be a once in a lifetime experience for a Muslim.

The *Hajj* is a test of patience and temperament – a spiritual, emotional, and physical challenge. However, it offers Muslims the opportunity to refresh our spiritual selves, to cleanse us of our sins and to draw closer to Allah (SWT). **As Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) said:**

> Whoever performs Hajj for the sake of Allah and does not utter any obscene speech or do any evil deed, will go back (free of sin) as his mother bore him.

Hadith | Bukhari and Muslim

***Hajj* takes place each year between the 8th and 12th of Dhul Hijjah**. Muslims use the lunar calendar, so the corresponding Gregorian date will vary year to year.

This year, *Hajj* is taking place between 14th June to the 19th June 2024 in the Gregorian Calendar.

This handy and comprehensive *Hajj* guide will help you understand the different aspects of the holy pilgrimage, from its origin, to how to perform Hajj.

The Story Of Hajj

While *Hajj* is something that was taught to Muslims by the Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him), its origin actually dates back to the teachings of another of Islam's beloved Prophets, Ibrahim (AS) (which means upon him be peace), thousands of years before.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) began the *Hajj* in 628 CE during the month of Dhul Hijjah, and is the same *Hajj* that Muslims perform today.

However, Dhul Hijjah was also a sacred month for the pagan Arabs in pre-Islamic Arabia.

During this month, fighting was forbidden for the Arabs, and they also made pilgrimage to the *Kaa'ba* – the cubic like structure in *Masjid al-Haram*, that at the time was being used to house the Arabs' pagan idols.

It is known today by Muslims as *Baitullah, or 'the House of God'.* It plays an important part in the rites of *Hajj* but is ultimately a mosque and not something that Muslims worship.

In fact, the *Kaa'ba* was built by Ibrahim (AS), or Prophet Abraham, thousands of years earlier by the command of Allah (SWT) – it is because of Ibrahim (AS) that Muslims perform *Hajj*.

Hajar, Isma'il (AS) And The Well Of Zamzam

Ibrahim (AS) *or Khalilullah* (the friend of Allah) as he is referred to, is considered to be one of the greatest of Allah's (SWT) creations. His reflective nature and the soundness of his heart brought him to the revelation of one God, Allah (SWT) – Ibrahim's (AS) story of prophethood is well documented in the Islamic tradition.

During his prophethood, Ibrahim (AS) encountered several trials that serve as reminders and lessons to mankind regarding devotion to Allah (SWT), sacrifice, faith, as well as other crucial tenets of Islam. These trials include the test of Ibrahim's (AS) willingness to sacrifice his son Isma'il (AS) for the sake of Allah (SWT), and the test of leaving his wife Hajar and son Isma'il (AS) alone in the desert of Makkah – it is this test that provides the basis for *Hajj*.

By the instruction of Allah (SWT), Ibrahim (AS) was to leave Hajar and Isma'il (AS) in the ancient desert of Makkah. The little food and water that they had soon ran out, and Isma'il (AS), an infant at the time, was crying of thirst. Hajar, desperately in search of water, ran between the nearby hills of *Safa and Marwah* in the hope of spotting someone who may be able to help.

Hajar returned to find Isma'il (AS) striking and scraping the ground with his leg in distress, when suddenly a spring burst forth from the barren desert. By the command of Allah (SWT), a source of water from deep within the earth (that is still in use today), provided Hajar and Isma'il (AS) with water – this is known as the well of Zam Zam.

The water source provided a means of trade for Hajar, with passing nomads exchanging food and other provisions for water. The site became prosperous for Hajar and her son, and when Ibrahim (AS) was commanded to return to them in the desert, he was amazed to see the miracles that had unfolded for them, and the fruits of his faith in Allah (SWT).

The Construction Of The Kaa'ba

It was at the site of the well of Zam Zam that Ibrahim (AS) was commanded to build the Kaa'ba.

Ibrahim (AS) and his son Isma'il (AS) worked together to build a small stone structure called the Kaa'bah. It was built to mark a space for the sacred gathering of Muslims – all those who believed in the one God, Allah (SWT).

The Inception of Hajj (The Sacred Pilgrimage)

As time elapsed, the site of the miracle well of ZamZam and the Kaa'bah would provide the means for Makkah to become a thriving and prosperous settlement. Ibrahim (AS) returned to the site each year to offer his pilgrimage to Allah (SWT), and years later, when Isma'il (AS) was given his prophethood, he continued the tradition – the inception of the *Hajj*.

However, during the thousands of years that would pass, the site that was built to commemorate the lessons of Ibrahim's (AS) trial, the miracle of Allah (SWT) and most importantly the belief in one God, was taken over by pagan Arabs and the worship of idols and spirits. This now thriving and prosperous settlement grew into a city for trade and the worship of pagan Gods – of which the Kaa'ba would eventually house.

Thousands of years later, a man named Muhammad, born into the highstatus *Quraysh* tribe of Makkah, would be given revelation and prophethood. The last of Allah's (SWT) messengers, Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him), established Islam in the land for mankind – with this came the commandment to restore the Kaa'ba to its original purpose and resume *Hajj*. The first Hajj was performed in In 632 CE, by the Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him), re-establishing the traditions started by the Prophet Ibrahim (AS).

Hajj As We Know It Today

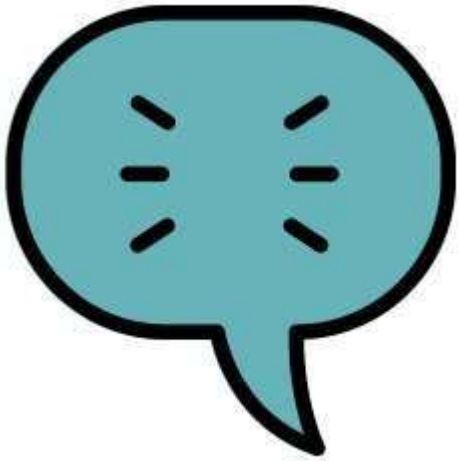
Today, over 2.5 million Muslims of every race, class, and culture around the world travel to Makkah each year in Dhul Hijjah, to stand equal before Allah (SWT) and fulfil the rites of *Hajj*.

Some people save up money their entire lives to be able to perform *Hajj*, while others are able to fulfil it more than once. Regardless of whether you've yet been able to attend or not, the month of Dhul Hijjah holds countless blessings for Muslims around the world! During the month of Dhul Hijjah, Muslims can even achieve a similar reward to that of going to *Hajj* by seeking special reward during this holy month. Find out more about the benefits of Dhul Hijjah here.

Who Is Eligible To Perform Hajj?

Hajj forms one of the five pillars of Islam. As such, all Muslims must perform *Hajj* at least once in their lifetime.

The five pillars of Islam:

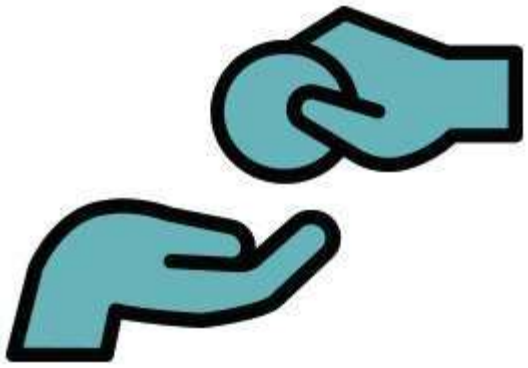


Shahada (Profession of Faith)

The belief and declaration that “There is no god but God, and Muhammad is the Messenger of God”



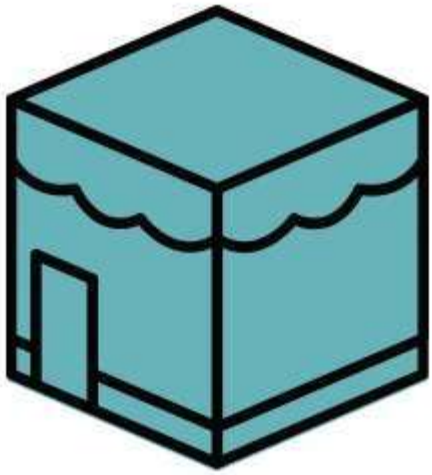
Salah (Prayer)



Zakat (Alms giving)



Sawm (Fasting)



Hajj (Pilgrimage)

However, there are still certain conditions that need to be met in order to perform *Hajj*:

1. Firstly, only Muslim adults (whether male or female) are required to perform *Hajj*. This means that while children may go to *Hajj*, it is not required of them.
2. Secondly, the very weak, sick, elderly, or otherwise physically incapable Muslims are exempt from having to perform the pilgrimage.
3. Thirdly, the Muslim must be **financially able** to perform *Hajj*. This means that a person in debt is not obliged to perform *Hajj* until he has cleared his debt – and must have the intention of doing so as a priority. However, if one is in debt, they may still perform *Hajj* as long as:

- The creditor permits it
- The debtor has time to pay off the debt
- Hajj does not affect their ability to pay off the debt

A Step-By-Step Guide To Performing Hajj

SubhanAllah, each and every year, around 25,000 Muslims from the UK travel to the holy cities of Makkah to perform *Hajj*, in unity with Muslims from all over the globe.

So, if you're one of these pilgrims heading off to Saudi Arabia to fulfil this sacred pillar, read on! We've put together this handy step-by-step *Hajj* guide to help you through this blessed journey!

The 19 Steps Of Hajj At A Glance

1. Preparation and Intention
2. Enter state of Ihram
3. Tawaf x7

4. Safa and Marwa
5. Clip/Shave Hair (Umrah ends)
6. Resting and Praying
7. Enter state of Ihram
8. Arrive at Mina
9. Day of ‘Arafah
10. Muzdalifah (under the night sky)
11. Rami (stoning of the devil)
12. Hady
13. Shaving of the Head
14. Tawaf al-Ifadha
15. Saai’
16. Rami (stoning of the devil)
17. Spend night at Mina
18. Rami (stoning of the devil)
19. Farewell Tawaf al-Wida

When Do I Perform Hajj?

In the Islamic tradition, Muslims operate within the lunar calendar (as opposed to the Gregorian calendar), and *Hajj* takes place each year between the 8th to the 12th of Dhul Hijjah. However, the corresponding Gregorian dates differ year to year as the lunar calendar appears to shift forward approximately 11-12 days. These days, *Hajj* pilgrims travel to Makkah by land, air and sea during the days and weeks prior to the pilgrimage period. If you’re travelling from the UK, you are likely to fly to Saudi Arabia, touching down in Jeddah or Medina.

From there you will travel with your *Hajj* group to Makkah.

How Do I Perform Hajj?

There are three forms of Hajj: *Tamattu*, *Ifraad* and *Qiran*.
For the purpose of this *Hajj* guide, we will use the ***Tamattu* form of Hajj**, which is what the Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) encouraged the Muslims to perform.

Here are the 19 steps of *Hajj* in detail:

1. Preparation and Intention

Before you arrive at Makkah to begin *Hajj*, it’s important to make your intention (*niyyah*) within your heart. The intention must be to perform the *Hajj* for the sake of Allah alone, with a desire for good in the hereafter. It should not be done with the intention of being seen by others or for worldly gain.

2. Entering The State Of Ihram

Next, you'll enter into the state of *Ihram* (ritual purity). For men, this means wearing the designated white cloth with one piece wrapped around your shoulder and one around your waist. Ladies may wear any clothing of their choice but should ensure they observe the rules of *Hijab*. Face coverings, however, are not permitted. Fully-covering shoes are also not permitted. Footwear must be in the form of sandals for both women and men.

Ihram describes the spiritual state you enter once you have made the intention to go to *Hajj*. When over 2.5 million pilgrims descend into Makkah, there should not be any outward distinction between them. Everyone stands equal before Allah (SWT) – one's status, race, culture, and wealth are irrelevant. The rules around the clothing of *Ihram*are **extremely simple, yet strict and must be adhered to.**

Throughout these holy days and whilst in the state of *Ihram* , we should also be particularly mindful of our behaviour and words. We should avoid smoking, engaging in sexual relations, swearing, shaving our hair, and cutting our nails. We must also not use perfume or scented soaps.

Once you arrive at the holy Masjid al-Haram in Makkah, with these preparations in mind, you're ready to start the biggest spiritual journey of your life!

- Tip: Carry spare *Ihram* clothing if you can. As for sandals, we recommend investing in a decent pair of trekking sandals. They tend to be the most comfortable and practical, given that you will be walking long distances on tarmac as well as gravel. Try and wear-in your sandals before you depart for Saudi so that you don't break out in blisters or face discomfort once you're there.

Upon arrival in Makkah, you must first perform your *Umrah*, which means you will do your *Tawaf* and *Sa'i* as outlined in the next steps.

3. Tawaf x 7

Tawaf is one of the principal rites of the pilgrimage and refers to walking in circles around the *Kaa'bah* in an anti-clockwise motion.

One *Tawaf* is made up of seven complete circuits, with each one starting and ending at the black stone, which is situated within the *Kaa'bah*.

In addition to your *Tawaf,* you can also offer voluntary prayers to thank Allah (SWT) for arriving safely and to mark the start of this incredibly special spiritual journey.

4. Safa and Marwa

After you've performed your *Tawaf*, you'll then perform what's known as *Sa'i* **(**walking and running between the two hills of Safa and Marwa).

You'll begin the *Sa'i* on the hill of Safa and walk towards the hill of Marwa. You will eventually see the green marker, at which point you will run until the next green marker and continue walking until you

reach Marwa. This completes one lap. You will then return to Safa to complete your second lap. Your *Sa'i* is complete once you have performed a total of seven laps between the hills of Safa and Marwa.

This is an important ritual in memory of Prophet Ibrahim's (AS) wife Hajar, and her struggle in the desert in search of water for her son Prophet Isma'il (AS). ***Sa'i* symbolises the ongoing struggle that we encounter throughout our lives, as Hajar experienced herself.**

7. Clip/Shave Hair (Umrah Ends)

Once *Sa'i* is complete, men will have their hair clipped or shaved, whilst a woman clips her hair to the length of her fingertip. This marks the completion of your umrah, allowing you to leave *Ihram*, **until the 8th of Dhul Hijjah.**

- Tip: Be very patient here. You'll be tired from tawaf, and you might notice fellow pilgrims in a hurry to complete the *Sa'i*. Feel free to take your time. Take regular breaks, and drink Zam Zam water which is available between Safa and Marwa.

6. Resting and praying

Now that you've performed your Umrah, for the rest of this blessed month, you'll stay in Makkah to complete your spiritual journey of Hajj, surrounded by your fellow Muslim sisters and brothers, SubhanAllah! Make sure to get plenty of rest and make the best use of your time by performing sincere acts of worship. Your Hajj will begin on the 8th Dhul Hijjah.

7. Re-entering State of Ihram (Day 1/8th Dhul Hijjah)

Fulfilling your sacred obligation of Hajj will be the most spiritual period of your life *Insha'Allah* (God willing), filled with blessings and forgiveness from Allah (SWT)! **The 8th day of Dhul Hijjah marks the beginning of the days of Hajj** and the next stage of your spiritual journey. You'll purify yourself and enter the state of *Ihram* once again.

Rules of Ihram

It's very important to note that when you are in a state of *Ihram*, **you are not permitted to smoke, swear, shave, clip your nails, or engage in any form of sexual relations. Fighting and arguments are also forbidden, and participants are prohibited from hunting, killing, or unjustifiably breaking anything**. **You must also avoid scented products such as perfumes, moisturisers, makeup, or soaps.** You may, however, substitute them for unscented toiletries which are permissible to use.

Once you're all set to enter the *Ihram,* you'll begin reciting the following invocation called the *Talbiyah*:

لَبَّيْكَ اللَّهُمَّ لَبَّيْكَ، لَبَّيْكَ لَ شَرِيْكَ لكَ لَبَّيْكَ، إِنَّ الْحَمْدَ وَالنِ عْمَةَ لكَ وَالْمُلْكَ لشَرِيْكَ لكَ

Transliteration:

Labbayka Allāhumma labbayk. Labbayk lā shareeka laka labbayk. Inna al-ḥamda, wa n-'imata, Laka wal mulk. Lā shareeka lak.

Translation:

"Here I am, O Allah, here I am, here I am. You have no partner, here I am. Verily all praise and blessings are Yours, and all sovereignty. You have no partner."

You will then proceed with your Hajj group to the neighbourhood of Mina in Makkah, which is located roughly eight kilometres from the centre of Makkah.

- Tip: We would highly recommend carrying some essentials such as unscented sun cream, moisturiser, Vaseline and soap. Sun cream is particularly handy, especially if you have no hair as it is not permissible for men to cover their head or face whilst in ihram. Vaseline is also particularly valuable for both women and men to protect against painful rashes that may occur as a result of constant walking. All of these are readily available in Saudi Arabia.

8. Arrive At Mina

Once you arrive in the tent city (neighbourhood) of Mina, you'll settle into your allocated tent. Here you'll pray *Salah* (obligatory prayers), including Dhuhr, Asr, Maghrib, 'Isha and Fajr, **shortening your four-unit prayers to two units each, without combining them,**as stated in the Qu'ran.
You'll spend the night and pray to Allah (SWT), reading the Qur'an and preparing for day two. It's an important time for spiritual reflection and devotion, so try and make the most of this special night.

- Tip: Be patient here, as space inside the tents can be very tight, and you might find yourself very close to fellow pilgrims. The weather is likely to be very hot, so remember to keep yourself hydrated. The Saudi authorities have installed cold water stations in close proximity to all tents, so familiarise yourself with your surroundings. You may also notice that Hajj authority workers regularly stock up complementary cold drinks in cooler boxes next to your tent. They're there for you to consume, so enjoy them to quench your thirst, but don't forget the spiritual purpose of being there. ***9. Day of 'Arafah (Day 2/9th Dhul Hijjah)***

After sunrise in Mina, you'll then head to the plains of 'Arafah, reciting *Istaghfar* (asking for forgiveness) and making supplications – marking the Day of 'Arafah when we ask Allah (SWT) for forgiveness for our sins. Upon reaching the plains of Mount 'Arafah, pilgrims observe shortened Dhuhr and Asr prayers combined (two *rakat* instead of four). However, according to Abu Hanifa, the combining of Dhur and Asr is only valid if one prays behind the Imam in the Masjid. Therefore if one was to pray in the tent, then they should not combine both salah.

On this day, there will be a sermon delivered from Masjid al-Nimra on Mount 'Arafah.

Try to listen to the *Khutbah* (sermon) if possible. Your group may also facilitate a translation of this sermon in English.

The day of 'Arafah is one of the most important days for Muslims across the world, as Allah (SWT) refers to the Day of 'Arafah in Surah al-Maidah as the Day on which He perfected His religion, completed His favours upon His beloved Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) and approved Islam as a way of life!

The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) also said:

“There is no day on which Allah frees people from the Fire more so than on the day of ‘Arafah. He comes close to those (people standing on ‘Arafah), and then He reveals before His Angels saying, ‘What are these people seeking.”

Hadith | Muslim

So, be sure to stand on the plains of ‘Arafah and make lots of *Du’a* (supplication), focussing your energy on Allah (SWT), asking Him for forgiveness and blessings for you and your family. Don’t forget to include your friends, relatives, neighbours as well as the wider *Ummah* (community) in your *Du’a* on this special day.

- Tip: Don’t be tempted to exhaust your energy and trek up Mount ‘Arafah, also known as Jabal al-Rahmah, on this day. Jabal al-Rahmah is the hill from where the Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) delivered his sermon. There is no authentic source to suggest any benefit in trekking the hill itself or to undertake this climb as a religious ritual. The level area surrounding the hill is called the Plains of ‘Arafah and this is where you should be spending your time in contemplation and prayer.

10. Arrive in Muzdalifah

After sunset, you’ll depart ‘Arafah and head to Muzdalifah – an open plain between Mina and ‘Arafah. Once you reach Muzdalifah you’ll perform your Maghrib and ‘Isha *Salah*, one after the other, shortening the ‘Isha *Salah* to two *Rakat*.
As Abdullah ibn Umar (RA) narrates:

“The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) offered the Maghrib and ‘Isha prayers together at Muzdalifah with a separate *Iqama*h (second call to prayer) for each of them and did not offer any optional prayer in between them or after each of them.” [Bukhari]

Afterwards, you can then spend the night in worship or resting. The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) went to sleep until shortly before Fajr, choosing not to engage in night worship as he normally did. So, don’t be tempted to exhaust yourself but rest instead – you have a long day ahead of you!

While in Muzdalifah, you may also collect pebbles to perform *Rami* (the stoning of the devil) over the next three days.

The size of the pebbles should be similar to the size of date stones/seeds. **You will need a total of 49 pebbles.**

However, it is advised that you pick up a further 21 pebbles as a precautionary measure to bring your total up to 70.

When you proceed to the phases of throwing the pebbles at the *Jamarat (the stone pillars)*, you may miss the target, or some pebbles may fall from your hand. Therefore, it’s better to have more than to be short. Pebbles can also be collected from anywhere in Mina.

- Tip: At Muzdalifah, you will stay under the night sky. There are no tents or other accommodation facilities here. Although there are plenty of lights, it is still fairly dark. Try to stay near your group, as it is very easy to get lost among the thousands of pilgrims. Toilets and *Wudhu* facilities are available in Muzdalifah, but they will likely be crowded so patience must be exercised here.

We would highly recommend you use the toilets and freshen up before you leave 'Arafah.

11. Rami and Hady (Day 3/10th Dhul Hijjah & start of Eid al-Adha) The 10th of Dhul Hijjah is also called the *Yawm al-Nahr*, or the Day of Sacrifice (*Qurbani*).
After performing Fajr *Salah* you will depart Muzdalifah and go back towards Mina. Remember to continuously recite the *Talbiyah.*

On this day, Pilgrims perform the *Hady (sacrificial animal)* and also commence the first of three days 'stoning of the devil' rite or ***Rami.*** Muslims around the world also offer *Qurbani* during this time and begin the four-day festival of Eid al-Adha. We know this from this verse in the Qur'an:

"And when you are safe, then, whoever avails the advantage of the 'Umrah along with the Hajj shall make an offering of whatever animal is available. However, any one who finds none shall fast for three days during Hajj, and for seven days when you return; thus they are ten in all. This is for him whose family folk are not residents of Al-Masjid-ul-Harām." [Qur'an | 2:196]

Origin Of Rami (The Stoning Of The Devil)

The stoning of the *Jamarat* **–** otherwise referred to as the 'stoning of the devil' **–** is a ritual carried out by *Hajj* pilgrims whereby pebbles are thrown at three stone structures in Mina across three days.

The first day of stoning occurs on the 10th of Dhul Hijjah. On this day Muslims also offer Qurbani and celebrate Eid al-Adha.
The act of throwing stones at the *Jamara**t*** **is known as *Rami.*** The ritual of *Rami* is symbolic of the actions of Ibrahim (AS) when he was faced with the trial of having to sacrifice his son, Isma'il (AS) upon the commandment of Allah (SWT). On the way to carry out the commandment, Iblis (Satan) repeatedly tried to tempt Ibrahim's (AS) into disobeying Allah (SWT). As Ibrahim (AS) reached Jamarat al-Aqaba, Allah (SWT) ordered Angel Jibreel (AS) to instruct Ibrahim (AS) to throw seven stones at Iblis. He obliged, and Iblis fled immediately. The three *Jamarat* indicate the three places where Iblis tried to dissuade Ibrahim (AS) from obeying the command of Allah. However, the pillars do not contain Iblis, as many people are wrongly led to believe.

How To Perform The Rami (The Stoning Of The Devil)

On the 10th, 11th, and 12th day of Dhul Hijjah, you will perform *Rami* (the stoning of the devil). The size of the pebbles should be similar to the size of date stones or seeds. **You will need a total of 49 pebbles.**

You'll need a certain number of pebbles for each of the three days. The breakdown is as follows:

- 7 pebbles for the 10th of Dhul Hijjah
- 21 pebbles for the 11th of Dhul Hijjah
- 21 pebbles for the 12th of Dhul Hijjah

Try to carry four small pouches per person for your pebbles. UK coin bags are a good size and convenient to carry. Use the four pouches to group pebbles according to the breakdown above.

Once you reach the *Jamarat*, you will head to Jamarat al-Aqaba, which is the largest pillar, and here you will throw the first seven pebbles at the concrete pillar. You will only pelt this one pillar on the first day. Upon each throw, you'll say the *takbir*:
" اللہ أکْبَر هرَ "

Transliteration:

"Allāhu 'Akbar" Translation:
"Allah is The Greatest"

- Tip: Don't rush to perform the Rami. The Hajj authority will most likely allocate a set time for your group to go and perform Rami. They do this to minimise overcrowding and the risk to pilgrims.

Try not to get angry and throw your sandals or other valuable possessions at the pillars. **Iblis is not contained within the pillar,** so you'll only lose your valuables and there is no benefit in doing so! ***12. Qurbani and Eid al-Adha***

The festival of Eid al-Adha, or the Feast of Sacrifice, is also celebrated by Muslims around the world on this day who are not on pilgrimage on the 10th Dhul Hijjah. By offering *Qurbani* (sacrifice), Muslims mark Prophet Ibrahim's (AS) willingness to sacrifice his son Isma'il (AS) upon the commandment of Allah (SWT).

13. Shaving The Head (Day 4/11th Dhul Hijjah)

After offering the *Hady,* you will proceed to shave or trim your hair if you are male. The Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) shaved his hair and this is preferable. A woman trims her hair by the length of a fingertip. Now you are allowed to leave the state of *Ihram* and wear comfortable clothing. You are also allowed to resume otherwise Halal activities that were forbidden in the *Ihram*, except for sexual intimacy. It is *Sunnah* (practice of the Prophet PBUH) to apply perfume as the Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) smelt strongly of musk at this point.

- Tip: Use disposable blades to shave each other's head within your group. If that's not possible, you'll notice a number of barbers in Mina ready to shave your head for a price. Ensure that the barbers use new blades to avoid infection.

14 & 15. Tawaf al-Ifadha and Saai' (Day 5/12th Dhul Hijjah)

You will now go to Makkah to perform *Tawaf al-Ifadha* and then another circuit of *Saai'*as part of your *Hajj* rituals.

Tawaf al-Ifada and *Sa'i* are obligatory. You must perform the *tawaf al-Ifadha* and the *Saai'* after the *Rami,* the *Qurbani* (sacrifice) and shaving (or trimming) of the head.

With the completion of the *Tawaf* and *Saa'i,* you are then allowed to relax and do everything that was lawful before entering the *Ihram*, including engaging in marital relations.

You will, however**, return to your tents in Mina and continue with the remaining rituals of Hajj.**

- Tip: The Tawaf area will be extremely crowded during this time. Try to use the upper levels of the Haram or the roof. You might want to do this around midnight when it tends to be quieter.

16. The Second Day of Rami

On the 11th Dhul Hijjah, you will proceed to your second day of Rami (the stoning of the devil).

On this occasion you pelt each of the three pillars in order. You will begin with Jamarah al-Ula (the small pillar), then Jamarah al-Wusta (the second/middle pillar) and finally, Jamarah al-Aqaba (the third/large pillar). You stop after the first and second Jamarat to make Du'a facing the qibla. Each one should be stoned with seven consecutive pebbles accompanied by the Takbir. Remember to take your spare pebbles with you in case you lose some!

17. Spend the night in Mina

Once your second *Rami* is completed, **you will return to your camp in Mina and spend the rest of the day and night in worship, making the most of the remaining time you have**

18. The Third Day of Rami

On the afternoon of 12th Dhul Hijjah, you'll have your final batch of pebbles (21 pebbles) ready to repeat the same steps as the previous day.

19. Tawaf al-Wida (The Farewell Tawaf)

You've now only one step left to perform **before completing *Hajj* and departing from Makkah. The farewell *Tawaf* is the last rite Muslims must perform.** This *Tawaf* is *Wajib* (obligatory) according to Hanafis, Shafi'is and Hanbalis but Sunnah according to Malikis and must be performed prior to leaving the boundaries of the *Haram*. Omitting this *Tawaf*, without a valid reason, **is not deemed lawful in Islam. Ibn Abbas (RA) narrated:**
"The people were ordered to perform the Tawaf al-Wida as the last thing before leaving (Makkah), except the menstruating women who were excused. " **[Bukhari]** For this *Tawaf*, you will complete seven laps of *Tawaf*. Then perform two *Rakat* of *Salah* and drink Zam Zam water. There is no *Sa'i* or shaving/trimming of the head after this *Tawaf*. **Hajj Mabrook! You've now completed your Hajj!**

For those of us who are unable to travel and perform *Hajj*, don't despair! The best ten days of the year are 1st to the 10th of Dhul Hijjah.

These days are a second chance to earn the mercy and forgiveness of Allah (SWT) after Ramadan.

For those of us who haven't been able to go to *Hajj* this year, we should use this blessed time to do more good deeds. These can include anything such as giving charity, honouring one's parents, upholding the ties of kinship, and enjoining what is good and forbidding what is evil. It is also important to enhance our

obligatory acts of worship by being mindful of our prayers and ensuring we pay our *Zakat* on time. For those of us who have not yet completed the pilgrimage of *Hajj,* this is also an ideal time to make *Du'a* that Allah (SWT) grants us the opportunity when He deems best.

Our Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) said:

There are no days that are greater before Allah or in which good deeds are more beloved to Him, than these ten days, so recite a great deal of Tahleel (saying of la illaaha illa Allah), Takbeer (saying of Allahu Akbar) and Tahmeed (Alhamdulillah) during them.

Hadith | Ahmad

It's highly recommended for you to fast and remember Allah (SWT) as much as you can.

The Qurbani for non-travellers is *Sunnah muakkadah* (confirmed Sunnah) according to most scholars and *Waajib* (a religious duty) according to the Hanafis. If you can afford to offer the sacrifice, then you are encouraged to do so. This would be in remembrance of the struggle and dedication of Prophet Ibrahim (AS) to Allah (SWT) and support a family in need.

Give your *Zakat* and *Sadaqah* during the blessed days of Dhul Hijjah and reap the rewards of this blessed month.

Don't forget to give your *Qurbani* in time for Eid!